In some states, Panchayat Courts try petty civil and criminal cases. They are variously known as Nyaya Panchayat, Gram Kutchery, Adalati Panchayat, Panchayat Adalat and so on.

Table 35.1 Articles Related to Subordinate Courts at a Glance

Article No.	Subject-matter
233.	Appointment of district judges
233A.	Validation of appointments of, and judgements, etc., delivered by certain district judges
234.	Recruitment of persons other than district judges to the judicial service
235.	Control over subordinate courts
236.	Interpretation
237.	Application of the provisions of this Chapter to certain class or classes of Magistrates

[1]The 20th Constitutional Amendment Act of 1966 added a new Article 233-A which retrospectively validated the appointment of certain district judges as well as the judgements delivered by them.

[2]In practice, the State Public Service Commission conducts a competitive examination for recruitment to the judicial service of the state.

[3]A subordinate judge is also known as civil judge (senior division), civil judge (class I) and so on. He/she may also be given the powers of an assistant sessions judge. In such a case, he/she combines in himself/herself both civil as well as criminal powers like that of a District Judge.

[4]A munsiff is also known as civil judge (junior division), civil judge (class-II) and so on.

[5]Delhi, Bombay, Calcutta and Madras were formerly called presidency towns.